

GOVERNANCE SYSTEM

After the Revolt of 1857, the control over India shifted from the mercantile East India Company (EIC) to the British Crown. An act, called the Government of India Act of 1858, was passed by the Parliament to bring this into effect. The restructuring that followed included breaking up of some parts of the "Presidencies" to form "provinces". Thereafter, the system of governance that came about entailed "British India", which included Presidencies and provinces directly administered by the British, and the "Princely States", which were governed by local rulers. The latter enjoyed some autonomy in exchange for recognition of British rule.